

Environmental E-05 Drowning / Near Drowning BLS

Revised 3/1/2000

PRIORITIES:

- ABCs
- Treat hypoxia
- Protect C-Spine
- Minimize time at scene
- Full arrest should be stabilized at scene
- Assure an advanced life support response
- Consider associated trauma to C-Spine to be present until proven otherwise

Drowning

Loss of consciousness in water, no in full arrest

1. Treat as CARDIOPULMONARY ARREST, with considerations for hypothermia and spinal precautions.

Near Drowning

Loss of consciousness in water, NOT in full arrest.

1. Ensure a patent airway (suction as necessary)
2. Be prepared to support ventilation with appropriate airway adjuncts and OXYGEN THERAPY as appropriate;
3. Protect the cervical spine, if neck injury suspected;
4. Anticipate vomiting. Take precautions against aspiration; be prepared for suctioning;
5. Remove wet clothing; keep patient warm and dry;
6. Monitor vital signs frequently;
7. Assist advanced life support personnel with patient packaging and movement to ambulance.

**Environmental
E-05 Drowning / Near Drowning**

PRIORITIES

- ABCs
- Protect C-Spine
- Search for associated injuries; assume C-Spine trauma
- Early transport.
- **EARLY CONTACT OF RECEIVING HOSPITAL.**

**Reviewed
July 2006**

PATIENT TREATMENT GUIDELINES

- Stabilize airway.
- Treat CARDIOPULMONARY ARREST per specific protocols;
- **OXYGEN** – High flow; be prepared to use appropriate adjuncts.
- Anticipate vomiting. Take precautions against aspiration, be prepared for suctioning;
- Remove wet clothing; keep patient warm and dry.
- CARDIAC MONITOR;
- IV Access and 250 cc fluid challenge if indicated for hypotension. Repeat vital signs and continue fluid boluses until systolic blood pressure is >100.
- Transport patient as early as possible.

DISRUPTED COMMUNICATIONS

In the event that a Solano County EMT-P is UNABLE to make physician contact for orders, the paramedic MAY NOT utilize those areas of the protocol needing physician direction and MUST TRANSPORT IMMEDIATELY TO THE CLOSEST FACILITY.